

Milo's Big Backyard Adventure

Little adventurers • 3-4 years old



Part 1: The Big Backyard Plan

Milo was four years old. He wore his yellow rain boots, even though the sun was out. "Boots make me brave," he said.

Today, the backyard felt like a wild land.

Milo held a small backpack. Inside were a blanket, a flashlight, a cup, and two crackers. Mom knelt beside him. "Adventure is fun," she said, "and we stay safe. You stay where I can see you."

Milo nodded. "I stay close. I look. I listen."

He walked to the big bush near the fence. It was his "forest." A butterfly floated by like a tiny kite.

Milo found a good spot. Soft grass. Shade from the tree. "This is Camp Milo!" he announced.

But then he saw it.

A line of ants marched right through his camp spot.

"Oh," Milo whispered. "Tiny travelers."

He thought hard. "I can't step on them. That would not be kind."

He looked around. He found two flat sticks and a little bowl. He had an idea.

Part 2: Camp Milo, Carefully

Milo put the sticks on the grass like a small bridge. He placed the bowl on top,

like a tunnel roof.

“Ants, you can go under,” he said softly. “I will go around.”

Mom watched from the patio. She smiled and called, “Good thinking, Milo!”

Milo spread his blanket a little to the side. He checked the ground with his eyes first, then his boots. “Step, step, safe step,” he said.

Next, he saw a shiny bottle cap near the tree. It sparkled like treasure.

Milo picked it up and held it high. “Treasure!”

Mom said, “Careful. Is it clean?”

Milo remembered. He used a leaf like a tiny glove. “Leaf hands!” he giggled. Then he put the cap into a small jar Mom gave him.

Now it was time for camp.

He sat on the blanket. He took a sip of water. He ate one cracker. “I am a careful camper,” he said.

A little breeze made the leaves clap. Milo laughed. “The trees are cheering!”

Part 3: Cozy Adventure Ending

When the sun began to go down, Mom walked over. “Ready to pack up?”

Milo nodded. “Yes. We leave it nice.”

He picked up the sticks and bowl. The ants kept marching, happy and safe. He folded the blanket with Mom’s help. He checked the grass. “No trash. No pokes.

All good.”

Mom hugged him. “You were brave, smart, and gentle.”

Milo leaned into her. “Tomorrow,” he said, “we can explore again. But we stay safe.”

“Always,” Mom said.

They went inside, warm and proud, with a little jar of “treasure” and a big, calm smile.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) What did Milo wear on his feet?

- yellow rain boots
- red hat
- blue shoes
- green gloves

2) What did Milo call his backyard spot?

- Camp Milo
- Pirate ship
- Space station
- Cozy house

3) What did Milo do when he saw the ants?

- step on them
- put sticks and bowl to make a bridge and go around
- put all ants in his jar
- run inside

4) Who watched Milo from the patio?

- Dad
- Mom
- Neighbor
- Dog

Correct answers:

1) yellow rain boots 2) Camp Milo 3) put sticks and bowl to make a bridge and go around 4) Mom

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Backyard: The outdoor area behind a house where children can play.

Backpack: A bag you wear on your back to carry things for a trip.

Flashlight: A small light you hold in your hand to see in the dark.

Crackers: A thin, crunchy bread snack you can eat on a trip.

Forest: A place with many trees and plants, like a small wood.

Butterfly: A pretty insect with big colorful wings that flies.

Travelers: People or animals that are moving from one place to another.

Bridge: Something you put across a gap so you can go over it.

Tunnel roof: The top part of a tunnel that covers the space underneath.

Patio: A flat outdoor place next to a house where people sit.

Bottle cap: The small lid that closes a bottle to keep it closed.

Breeze: A soft, gentle wind that moves leaves and hair.

Gentle: Being kind and soft, not rough or hard with others.